Yoorim Son

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Sogang University
M.A. Student in Economics
Seoul, Korea

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Education

Sogang University, Seoul, Korea Mar 2025-present
M.A. in Economics; expected graduation: 2027
Advisor: Hyunjoo Yang
BK21 FOUR (Brain Korea 21), Participating Graduate Student Sep 2026-Feb 2027
AI-Economics Convergence Education and Research Group
for Addressing Korea's Economic Challenges

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies Mar 2017-Feb 2021
B.A. in South African Languages and Cultures; Yongin, Korea
Minor in Political Science and Diplomacy

University of Botswana, Gaborone, Botswana Jan-May 2018
Visiting / Exchange Student; coursework in Political Science

Research Interests

Development economics; applied microeconomics; digital infrastructure; local economic development and spatial inequality; geospatial and satellite-based economic measurement.

Working Papers

Mobile Broadband Upgrading and Spatial Inequality in South Africa October 2026
(with Hyunjoo Yang).
Uses quarterly Ookla data to examine how mobile broadband upgrading during South Africa's 2021-2024 spectrum transition varies with initial quality, poverty, and regulatory priority.
Narrowing low-speed disadvantage
can coexist with widening absolute speed gaps across municipalities.

Research Experience

Sogang Spatial Economics & AI Lab Apr 2026-present
Research Assistant to Hyunjoo Yang, Sogang University

Satellite-Based Global Crop Mapping and Yield-Prediction Design Sep 2026
Constructed maize and rice ground-truth data and completed rice sampling; am developing XGBoost features for crop-area prediction.

North Korean Industrial Production and Economic Activity Aug 2026
Supported a Bank of Korea collaboration using daytime satellite imagery, atmospheric gas data, and AI to measure North Korean industrial production and economic activity.

Research Experience (continued)

MIRACLE: Subnational Economic Data for South Korea, 1960-1989 Nov 2025-present
Research Assistant to BooKang Seol (LSE)
Project Leads: BooKang Seol (LSE), Changkeun Lee, and Hyunjoo Yang

Help build a consistent township-year economic panel from historical yearbooks and archival records.

Completed administrative-region data collection, coordinated a five-person team, and now work on OCR extraction and processing.

Seminars & Conferences

2026 Korean Economic Review (KER) International Conference June 22, 2026
Halla Convention Center, Jeju, South Korea

The Economic Impact of Submarine Cable Arrival on Local Economic Activity: Evidence from South Africa (with Hyunjoo Yang).
Presenter; Contributed Session A5: Empirical Microeconomics

Examines how international connectivity gains translate into local broadband upgrading and economic activity in South Africa.

Methods & Data

Programming: Python.
Empirical methods: Fixed effects, event studies, spatial exposure designs, synthetic-control diagnostics; training in difference-in-differences and instrumental variables.
Machine learning: XGBoost, sampling, and feature construction.
Data: Panel and administrative data, broadband performance, GIS and satellite-derived measures, historical archives, crop ground-truth data, and OCR workflows.

Languages

Korean: Native; English: Intermediate (academic reading and writing).